

A short, consistent, low-pressure conversation to place each student in the right class — **A1, A1.2, A2, or B1+ Conversation** — and to note their availability so we can form groups. There is no pass or fail; the goal is simply to find where they are and what suits them.

How the 15-minute check flows

- 1 **Welcome** · 1–2 min · English
Put them at ease — a friendly chat, no test, no wrong answers. Ask what drew them to Portuguese.
- 2 **Warm up in Portuguese** · 2 min
Simple greetings and introductions. See what they can produce on their own.
- 3 **Work up the ladder** · 5–6 min
Climb the diagnostic prompts below; stop where they can no longer respond with ease.
- 4 **Let them speak** · 2–3 min
A minute on a familiar topic, to gauge fluency and confidence.
- 5 **Goals & times** · 2 min
What they want from the course, and which days/times suit — mornings or evenings.
- 6 **Close** · 1 min
Thank them; say you'll follow up with their level and the right class.

Level rubric

LEVEL	CAN TYPICALLY...	YOU'LL HEAR
A1 Complete beginner	Little to no Portuguese.	Falls back to English straight away; a few isolated words at most.
A1.2 Continuing beginner	Greet, introduce themselves, give basic personal info, use the present tense of common verbs, ask simple questions.	Comfortable with "Como se chama? De onde é?" Struggles with the past tense.
A2 Post-A1 / Elementary	Handle everyday exchanges — routine, family, work, ordering — using past and near-future tenses.	Uses the pretérito perfeito, links ideas, communicates despite errors.
B1+ Conversation	Hold a conversation, give opinions, tell stories, cope with unexpected topics.	Speaks at length; wants fluency and practice, not grammar basics → Conversation class.

Diagnostic ladder

Ask in Portuguese; drop into English only to reassure, then return. Climb until they can no longer keep up.

- 1 *"Olá! Como se chama? De onde é? Onde mora?"* — **A1.2 can answer.**
- 2 *"O que gosta de fazer? A que horas se levanta?"* — **A2 answers with ease.**

- 3 “O que fez no fim de semana passado?” – A2+ reaches for the past tense.
- 4 “Porque quer aprender português? O que acha de viver em Lagos?” – B1+ elaborates.

Rule of thumb: place them at the highest rung they handle with reasonable ease. If they stall at a rung, drop one.

After the chat

Note for each student

- Name & contact
- Prior experience (self-reported)
- Observed level → recommended class
- Availability: mornings / evenings, which days
- Goals & motivation
- Anything else (confidence, specific needs)

Keep it warm

- Reassure often — “não há certo nem errado.”
- Stay in Portuguese as far as they can go; switch to English to comfort.
- Availability matters as much as level — it decides the groups.
- End with a clear next step: their level, the class, and how to reserve a September spot.